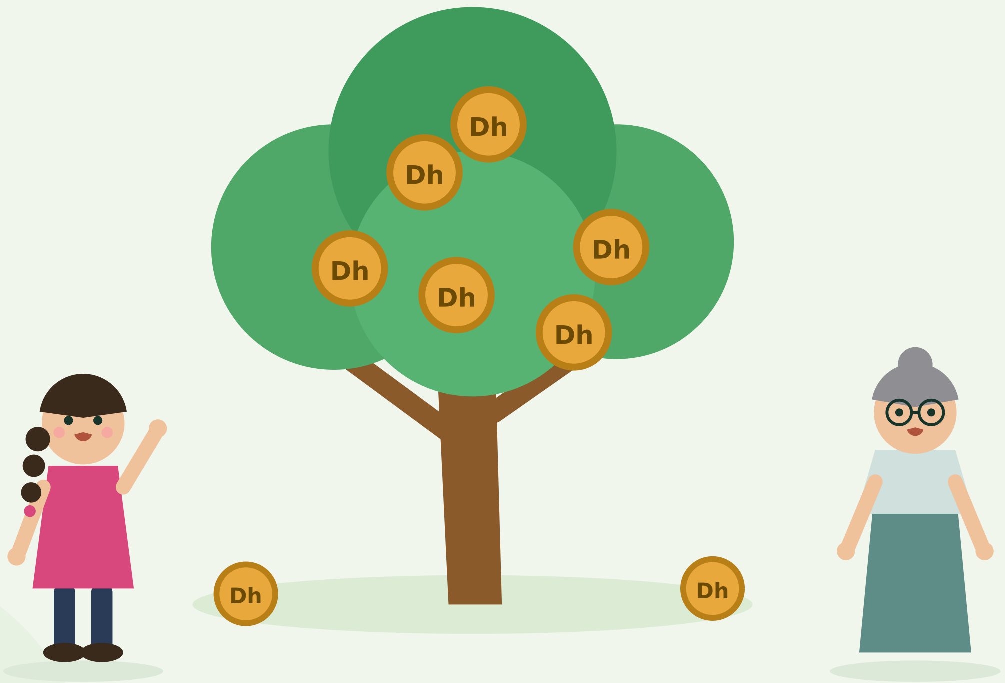
A HALAL MONEY STORY FOR YOUNG MUSLIM READERS · UNITED ARAB EMIRATES

Manahil
and the Five Thousand Dirhams

One envelope. One promise. One year that changed everything — told from Eid to Eid.



Her starting seed: AED 5,000 — a teaching amount

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2026

Manahil and the Five Thousand Dirhams

A halal money story for young Muslim readers

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School Edition · 2026

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A Halal Money Story · School Edition

Written by Nabeel Shaikh, FCA

First edition, 2026

Please read this: this book teaches ideas and habits, not instructions. Every dirham figure inside it is a teaching example — we mostly use 10% a year because the arithmetic stays friendly — and real returns rise, fall and are never guaranteed. Nothing here is financial advice or a religious ruling. Any account for a young person needs a parent or guardian, and real decisions belong with a licensed advisor and scholars your family trusts.

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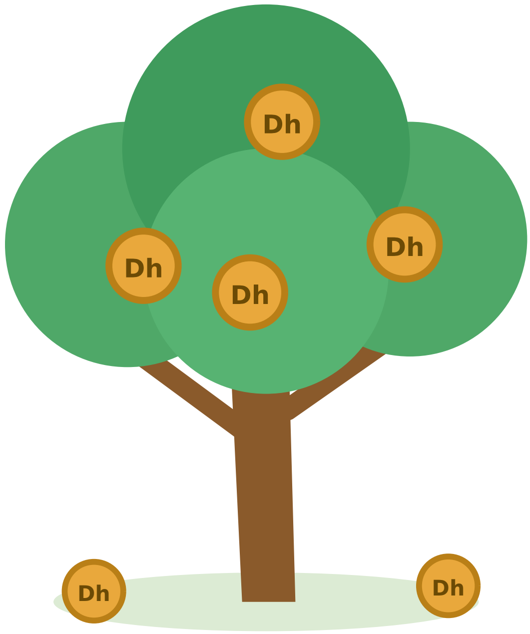
In the name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.

"*Allah has permitted trade and forbidden riba.*"

Surah Al-Baqarah 2:275

Every dirham you will ever hold is an **amanah** — a trust placed in your hands for a while. This is the story of a girl who was handed one, and chose to look after it properly.



for Manahil Shaikh

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May every dirham you ever hold be earned with honesty,
grown with patience, and shared with joy.
This little book is your Eid gift — plant it well.

Written by Nabeel Shaikh, FCA

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2026

Shared with schools and families everywhere,
so every child can walk this year beside Manahil.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to Read This Story

This is a story with a second job. On the surface it follows one twelve-year-old girl through a single year — from the Eid morning an envelope lands in her hands to the Eid morning she opens her notebook and counts what grew. Underneath, it hands you the whole map of honest money: what a dirham is, where it may safely live, what it must never touch, and how patience turns a small seed into something enormous.

Read it as a story. The lessons land the way they land in life: inside arguments, mistakes, brownie crumbs and one very frightening phone call. It is written for readers of roughly eleven to sixteen, and for the adults who will end up reading it over their shoulder.

A NOTE ON THE AMOUNT

AED 5,000 is a **teaching number, chosen only to make the sums friendly**. The real starting figure could be AED 500 or AED 1,000,000 — whatever you wish to hand a child for learning. Every rule in this story behaves the same at any size.

FOR THE YOUNG READER

One chapter a sitting. Manahil keeps a green notebook; keep one beside you. Every chapter ends with what she wrote and one small thing for you to do. Do those, and by the last page you will have earned the certificate waiting there.

FOR TEACHERS

The twenty-two chapters divide neatly into a twelve-week term; the planner near the back maps every week, its activity and its learning goal. Read the chapter aloud, act out the scene, then use YOUR TURN as the discussion starter. Photocopiable worksheets, a fifteen-question test and a certificate ceremony close the term.

FOR PARENTS AND GUARDIANS

Read along — money lessons stick best as conversations. Every account for a child needs a parent or guardian; each figure here (we mostly use 10% because the arithmetic stays friendly) is a teaching example, never a promise; and real decisions belong with your own licensed advisor and trusted scholars.

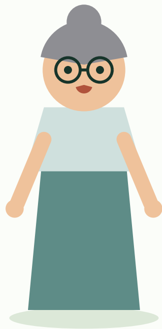
One promise before the story starts: nothing here asks you to be a genius. It asks you to be patient, honest and curious — three things every child already owns.

THE PEOPLE IN THIS STORY

Meet the Cast

Manahil

Twelve, and the heroine of every page. Asks the question nobody else dares to ask, then writes the answer in a green notebook she guards like treasure.

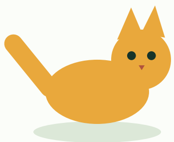


Grandma

Keeper of one condition — *every dirham earned cleanly*. Explains the largest ideas with the smallest objects: a jar, a scale, a mango tree.

Sara

The best friend, the loudest laugh, the fastest spender in the neighbourhood. Learns the hard way so you don't have to — and grows the most of anyone.



Motu

A cat of enormous opinions and no financial sense whatsoever. Sleeps on important papers. Steals one coin per chapter, roughly.

...and **you**, reading over Manahil's shoulder. Everything she works out this year works just as well for your money. Turn the page: it begins on Eid morning, with an envelope nobody expected.

FIND YOUR WAY

Contents

I

PART ONE

The Envelope

Before a single dirham is planted, Manahil must learn what money truly is, the two doors it can walk through, and how to give every dirham a job.

WHAT MANAHIL WORKS OUT HERE

✓ What a five thousand dirhams really means — and why the number stops being scary.

✓ Where money came from, and the three jobs it does all day.

✓ Needs, wants, and the three jars that tame any amount.

✓ Why spending feels rich while owning makes you rich.

✓ The thief who empties a mattress without touching it.

1

WHERE IT ALL BEGINS

The Best Eid Gift Ever

Eid morning smelled of three things: warm sweets from the kitchen, new cloth, and the henna still drying on Manahil's palms.

The house was at full volume. Cousins thundered up and down the stairs. An uncle argued cheerfully with the television. Motu, who considered all of this beneath him, had folded himself onto the softest cushion in the room and shut both eyes.

“Manahil.” Grandma's voice came from the chair by the window — the chair nobody else ever sat in. “Come here a moment.”

Manahil went. Grandma was holding an envelope, and she was holding it the way people hold something that matters. Not waving it. Not offering it. Waiting with it.

The morning everything started — one chair, one envelope, one very unhelpful cat.

Inside was a cheque. Manahil read the number, blinked, and read it twice more, because her eyes had clearly made a mistake.

AED 5,000

Her eyes had made no mistake. One five thousand dirhams dirhams, written out in Grandma's careful handwriting, with Manahil's own name above it.

READING A NUMBER THAT BIG

AED 5,000 — five thousand dirhams. Say it slowly and it shrinks to a friendly, countable size.

AED 1,000,000 — **one million**. Far away today; a great deal closer than you think once you have read chapter 17. Keep that word somewhere safe; it returns at the end of this story, closer than you would think.

“It is real,” said Grandma, enjoying herself. “And it comes with one condition.”

Manahil looked up.

“It may only be grown the **halal** way. Clean, fair, honest. No shortcuts, no clever tricks, nothing forbidden — not one dirham of it.” Grandma raised a single finger. “Promise me that, or the envelope goes back in the drawer.”

“I promise,” said Manahil. She did not yet know the half of what she was promising. She meant it anyway, and that turned out to be enough.

“Good.” Grandma settled back. “Now the harder part. This money can vanish in a year, or it can feed you for a lifetime. Which one happens depends entirely on which door you send it through.”

“What doors?”

Grandma nodded at Manahil's own two hands.

DOOR ONE — SPEND IT

Toys, ice cream, burgers, a phone. Wonderful today.

The money walks out and never finds its way home.

DOOR TWO — PLANT IT

Put it to work so that it **earns money of its own**.

The money stays, keeps working — and treats still arrive.

A door that hands you treats *and* keeps the money? That sounded like magic, and Manahil said so.

“Not magic,” said Grandma. “**Investing**. Ordinary, patient, unglamorous investing — and by next Eid you will understand it better than most adults I know.”

Then she leaned forward, and her voice changed into the one she used for serious business.

> *“One year, my dear. Next Eid you will sit in this chair and tell me two things: what your money grew — and how it stayed clean.”*
>
> **— GRANDMA**

That was the whole challenge. It landed somewhere under Manahil's ribs and sat there, half terror and half thrill, for the rest of the day.

Upstairs, in the drawer of the spare room, she found a notebook with a green cover and nothing written in it. She carried it down, sat on the step outside where the noise was thinner, and wrote her first line.

FROM MANAHIL'S GREEN NOTEBOOK

Day one. I have AED 5,000 and one promise. Everything must be earned cleanly. By next Eid I have to show Grandma what grew — and I have no idea how yet.

★ MISSION ONE: ACCEPT THE CHALLENGE

The challenge is accepted, the notebook is open, and the promise is made. Manahil now has one year — and twenty-one chapters — to keep it.

YOUR TURN

If that envelope landed in your hands this morning, what is the honest first thing you would want to do with it — and which door does that belong to? Say it out loud before you turn the page. No judging.

2

FIRST, UNDERSTAND IT

What Is Money, Really?

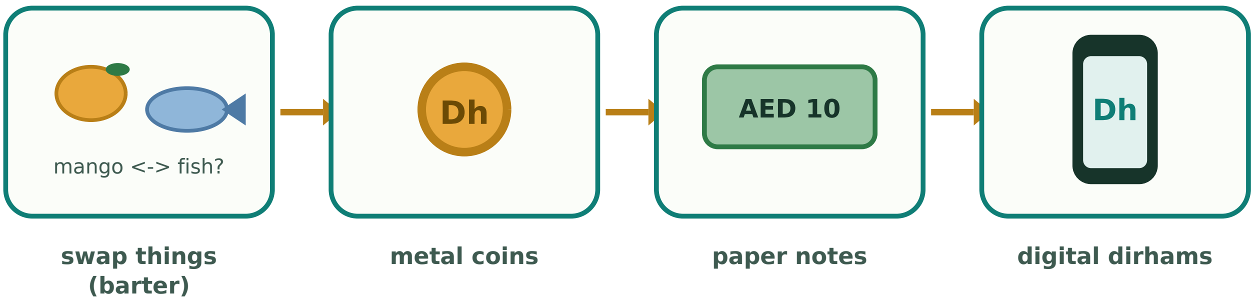
The question arrived at breakfast the next morning, the way the best questions do — sideways, while nobody was expecting it.

Manahil turned the envelope over in her hands. “Grandma. What actually *is* this? It is paper. Why would the shopkeeper hand me a basket of mangoes for a piece of paper?”

Grandma put down her cup, and her eyes did the twinkle that always meant a story was coming. “Ah. For that, we travel back four thousand years — to a fisherman who badly wanted mangoes.”

Long ago, she explained, there was no money at all. If you had mangoes and wanted shoes, you went hunting for a shoemaker who happened to want mangoes. And if he wanted fish instead? Then you had to find a fisherman who wanted mangoes, trade for fish, and carry the fish across town in the heat before the shoemaker changed his mind.

“That,” said Grandma, “is called **barter**. And it has a famous flaw. A swap only happens when both people want exactly what the other is holding. Two wishes must meet at the same moment. Most days, they do not.”



Four thousand years of shopping, in a single line.

So people picked one thing everybody would always accept. Shells, first. Then silver and gold coins. Then paper notes that stood in place of the coins. And today, mostly, dirhams are simply numbers moving between accounts and phones.

“Who decides how many exist?” asked Manahil, which is a very good question and one most adults never think to ask.

“the **Central Bank of the UAE**,” said Grandma. “It issues the dirham, and its Higher Shariah Authority checks that Islamic products truly are Islamic. Look at the note in your hand. Somebody promised something, and millions of us believed them. That belief is the whole invention.”

THREE JOBS, WRITTEN IN THE GREEN NOTEBOOK

Money does three jobs, every single day:

1. It swaps. Everyone accepts it, so nobody carries fish across town.

2. It measures. Prices let you compare a mango with a motorbike.

3. It stores. Earn today, spend next year — although chapter six reveals a thief who quietly drills a hole in this third job.

THE THOUGHT SHE UNDERLINED TWICE

A thousand-dirham note is paper and ink. It works because millions of strangers trust it. Money is **trust made visible** — which is exactly why the way you earn it matters as much as the amount.

Motu chose that moment to bat a coin off the table. It rolled under the sofa and was never seen again, which Manahil later decided was the day's second lesson.

YOUR TURN

Explain the double-wish problem to someone at home using only things in your kitchen — then ask them which of money's three jobs they would miss most if it vanished tomorrow.

3

EVERY DIRHAM NEEDS A JOB

Needs, Wants & the Three Jars

Sara arrived on Tuesday wearing seventeen brand-new hair clips, and she arrived loudly.

“I spent all of it!” she announced, spinning once in the doorway so the clips caught the light. “All my Eid money! On day one!”

Manahil waited for Grandma to say something sharp. Grandma said nothing at all. She simply walked to the kitchen and came back with three empty jars, which she set on the table in a row — clink, clink, clink.

“Sit,” she said to both girls. “Let me show you a trick older than banks.”

First, though, a sorting game. Grandma named things and the girls shouted which box each belonged in.

Needs — bread, clean water, school books, the uniform, bus fare, medicine. Things you cannot learn or live without. **Wants** — crisps, game top-ups, a data bundle, the sneakers everybody at school keeps posting about, a seventeenth hair clip.

“Are wants bad?” asked Sara, slightly defensive, one hand protecting her hair.

“Not remotely,” said Grandma. “Wants are the salt in the food. But there is an order: needs first, wants after — and both of them planned. A plan like that has a grown-up name.”

THE WORD SHE WROTE FIRST

Budget — a promise made *before* the spending starts, giving every single dirham a job. Not a punishment. A plan.

Then came the jars. Grandma labelled them in thick marker: SPEND, SAVE, GIVE.

One example split: half to spend, forty out of every hundred saved, ten given. Your family may choose different numbers.

“Whoever handles a thousand dirhams well,” said Grandma, “will handle a hundred thousand well. The size changes. The habit does not.”

She tapped the middle jar. “This one is the engine. Every dirham that lands in SAVE is a seed waiting for the right soil — and we spend the rest of this book finding that soil. And this one,” she tapped the third, “keeps your heart in as good health as your wallet. It comes back near the end, and it matters more than you expect."

THE HABIT THAT SEPARATES SAVERS FROM EVERYONE ELSE

Most people spend first and save whatever survives — and somehow nothing ever survives. Savers flip the order: **fill the SAVE jar the moment money arrives**, then spend the rest without a shred of guilt.

Sara looked at her seventeen hair clips. Then at the three empty jars. Then, for the first time in the history of Sara, she went quiet for a whole minute.

"Can I start with next month's pocket money?" she said.

"That," said Grandma, "is how every single one of us starts."

★ MISSION TWO: GIVE EVERY RUPEE A JOB

Manahil split her next pocket money into three jars the hour it arrived — and wrote the amounts on the first worksheet at the back of this book.

YOUR TURN

Find three jars, boxes or envelopes tonight. Label them SPEND, SAVE and GIVE, and split the very next money that reaches you — before it has a chance to slip away. Worksheet 1 is waiting at the back.

4

DOOR ONE, WALKED ALL THE WAY

The Ice Cream Problem

It was Sara who did the arithmetic, on her fingers, on the front step, in the orange light of a Thursday evening.

“Wait,” she said. Her fingers stopped. “If I keep going like this…”

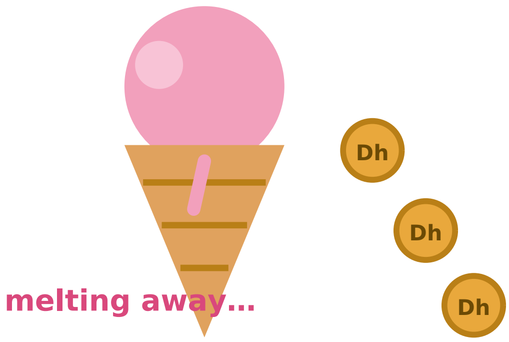
Grandma, who had been waiting patiently for exactly this sentence, handed each girl an ice cream. “Eat it slowly,” she said, “and watch what it does.”

They ate. The sun stayed warm. The lesson melted in, drip by drip.

“Before we refuse door one,” Grandma said, “we should walk all the way through it. Refusing something you never understood is not wisdom. It is luck.”

So they walked through it. Suppose Manahil spent on everything she loved:

A scoop of ice cream	**AED 15**
A chicken burger meal	**AED 40**
The sneakers everyone is posting about	**AED 600**
A fancy phone	**AED 4,500**
Roughly AED 150 a day…	**AED 5,000 gone in about a month**



Spent money behaves like ice cream in June — sweet for a moment, then simply gone.

“One month,” said Sara, appalled. “A whole five thousand dirhams, in one *month*.”

“And at the end of it,” said Grandma, “what remains? Nothing, plus one broken toy. But there is a second loss, and it is invisible, so almost nobody counts it.”

Manahil looked up from her notebook. “What second loss?”

“Everything that money would have *earned*, if you had let it live.”

THE INVISIBLE PRICE TAG

Opportunity cost — whatever you give up by choosing something else. Spend AED 15 on ice cream and the true cost is the ice cream *plus* everything that AED 15 could have grown into by the time you are twenty.

THE SENTENCE MANAHIL COPIED ONTO HER WALL

Spending *feels* rich. Owning *makes* you rich. Treats are entirely allowed — the trick is to buy them with the money your money earned, and never with the five thousand dirhams itself.

Sara wiped her hands and asked the question that opens the next chapter. “Fine. So how does money earn money without me doing anything?”

Grandma stood up and brushed down her clothes. “Come to the courtyard on Friday,” she said. “I will introduce you to something I have owned for thirty years.”

YOUR TURN

A friend says, “I'm rich — I spent all my Eid money in one day!” What would you gently tell her? And name both prices of the last thing you bought: the one on the label, and the invisible one.

5

DOOR TWO, AND ITS SECRET

Meet Your Money Tree

The thing Grandma had owned for thirty years turned out to be a tree.

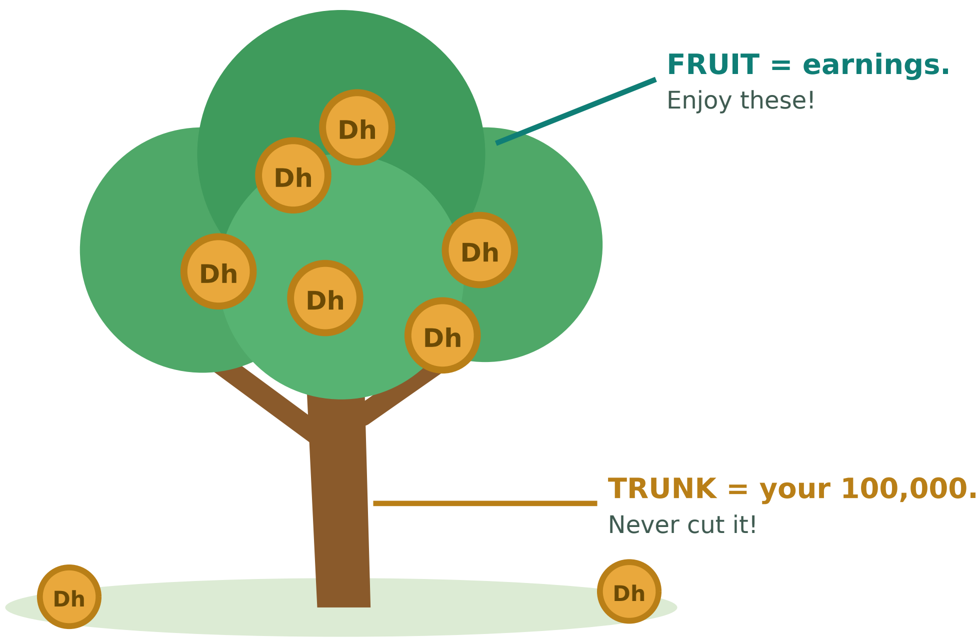
It stood in the corner of the courtyard, wide and untidy and heavy with mangoes, shading half the wall. Grandma put her hand flat against the trunk the way you greet an old friend.

“This tree has paid me every single summer for thirty years,” she said. “Do you know why?”

“Because you watered it?” offered Sara.

“Because in thirty years,” said Grandma, “I never once cut it down for firewood. Not in the cold winter. Not the year the roof leaked. Not once.”

She turned to Manahil. “Your envelope is not a pile of notes, my dear. It is a sapling. Look after it and every season it hands you fruit — eat it, share it, sell it, and next season there is more. Chop it down for one good week of firewood, and there is no tree, no fruit, no next season. Ever.”



One tree, two parts — and only one of them is for eating.

Manahil wrote three words in the green notebook that afternoon, and drew a small box around each one.

THE THREE WORDS THAT CHANGED HER MIND

Capital — the original money. The trunk. My AED 100,000.

Return — the new money my capital earns. The fruit.

Asset — anything I own that can pay me or rise in value. A tree is an asset. A burger is definitely not.

“Eat the fruit. Never cut the tree. Remember it on your best day and your worst one — especially your worst one.”

— GRANDMA

“That is the golden rule of everything that follows,” said Grandma. “Spend from what your money earns, as much as you like. But guard the trunk as though it were the last sapling in Multan.”

Sara was frowning at the mangoes. “So what is *my* tree?”

“You have not planted one yet,” said Grandma, kindly. “That is not a tragedy. It is a Tuesday.”

★ MISSION THREE: STOP SEEING A PILE, START SEEING A TREE

Manahil renamed the money in her head. It stopped being “a hundred thousand dirhams to spend” and became “a trunk that must never be cut” — the single most valuable rename of her entire year.

YOUR TURN

Walk around your home and sort five things into **asset** or **not an asset**. Is the family car an asset? The television? Somebody's gold bangles? Argue about at least one of them.

KNOW YOUR ENEMY

6 The Sneaky Thief Called Inflation

“Fine,” said Sara, folding her arms. “Then I won't spend mine and I won't plant it either. I'll hide it under my mattress where nothing can touch it.”

Grandma left the room and came back carrying a photograph album, which she opened at a picture of a girl about their age standing outside a shop with a shopping bag so full it was bursting.

“Your mother,” she told Manahil. “Twelve years old. And in that bag is fifty dirhams of shopping.”

Sara leaned in and made a small strangled noise. “Fifty dirhams? Today that is… one burger meal. Maybe.”

“Correct,” said Grandma. “Now meet the thief who never touches the money.”

same note… smaller shopping power

The note never changes. What it can carry home does.

The thief has a name every adult in the Emirates complains about: **inflation**, the slow, patient rise of prices, year after year after year. It does not break into houses. It does not need to. It simply makes the same note buy less each time you use it.

Grandma did the sum out loud. “Your favourite ice cream costs AED 15 today. At roughly ten out of every hundred added each year, next summer it is about 330. In ten summers, near 780.”

Manahil worked it forward and felt slightly ill. “So Sara's mattress money would still *say* a five thousand dirhams…”

“…and would buy what about AED 2,000 buys today,” Grandma finished. “More than half of it, quietly gone. No broken lock, no missing notes, no fingerprints. It is the most polite robbery in the world.”

WHY DOING NOTHING IS NOT SAFE

Money standing still is money quietly shrinking. To truly protect a hundred thousand, it has to grow *at least* as fast as prices climb. That is not greed — it is self-defence. Remember money's third job from chapter two, the storage box? Inflation is the leak in the bottom of it.

Sara unfolded her arms. “Right,” she said. “The mattress is out.”

Manahil wrote one line, closed the notebook and looked at the courtyard tree through the window with entirely new respect.

FROM MANAHIL'S GREEN NOTEBOOK

Standing still is not safe. If prices run and my money sits, I lose without spending a dirham. So the money has to work — and it has to work cleanly. That is the whole puzzle.

YOUR TURN

Become an inflation detective. Ask a parent or grandparent what a loaf of bread, a litre of petrol and one school fee cost when they were twelve. Write the old and new prices side by side on Worksheet 5 — then watch their face while they remember.

II

PART TWO

The One Condition

The promise Manahil made on Eid morning finally gets explained — and it turns out to be the heart of everything that follows.

WHAT MANAHIL WORKS OUT HERE

✓ What riba is, and why a deal that wins in every weather is unfair by design.

✓ The three checks every investment must survive before it is allowed near her money.

✓ Who the scholar-referees are, and the neat idea called purification.

✓ The four honest flavours in which money is allowed to pay you.

THE PROMISE, EXPLAINED

7 Grandma's Condition: What Makes Money Halal?

The explanation came at night, on the veranda, under a string of Eid lights that had not yet been taken down.

“Sit properly,” said Grandma. “This is the story I have been saving. Everything else in your year rests on it.”

Once, she began, there was a farmer who needed five thousand dirhams dirhams for seed. He had no savings and one season to plant. Two neighbours heard about it and each knocked on his door.

The first neighbour said: “Take my five thousand dirhams. Return one hundred and twenty thousand next year — whether your crop grows or drowns. Rain is your problem, not mine.”

“Now think,” said Grandma. “The rains fail. The crop dies. What does the farmer have?”

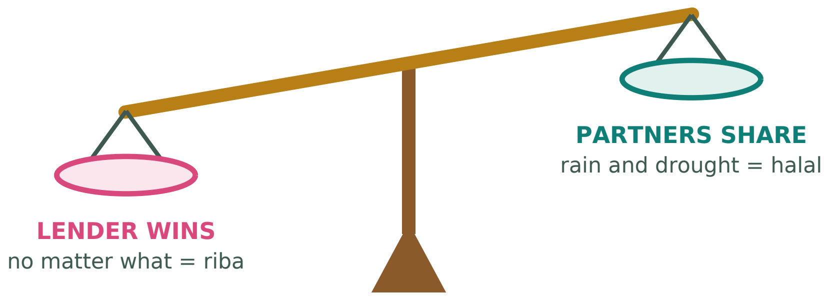
Manahil worked it through slowly. “No crop… and he still owes extra. He loses twice.” She looked up. “And the neighbour wins either way. He wins if it rains and he wins if it doesn't.”

“That,” said Grandma, “is **riba**. A guaranteed extra charged on lent money. It is forbidden, and not because somebody dislikes lenders. It is forbidden because it is *unfair by design*: one side carries every risk while the other side cannot lose.”

The second neighbour said something different: “Take my five thousand dirhams as your partner. If the crop sells well, we share the profit as agreed. If honest bad luck strikes, I share the loss with you.”

Same money. Same farmer. Completely different deal — because now two people stand under the same sky.

the fairness test



Riba tips the scale one way forever. Partnership keeps it honest.

“Money is allowed to earn,” said Grandma. “But it must join something real — real trade, real assets, real effort, real risk. Money must never simply breed money while sitting in a chair.”

THE THREE CHECKS — EVERY RUPEE MUST PASS ALL THREE

1. No riba. Money may not multiply just by being lent. It has to join real trade, real assets, real work.

2. No forbidden business. Nothing earned from alcohol, gambling, interest-banking, or anything else that harms people.

3. No gambling, no fog. No lucky-draw winnings (*maysir*), and no deal so murky that nobody can say what is being bought (*gharar*).

“But who checks?” asked Manahil. “I'm twelve. I can't inspect a whole company.”

“Nobody expects you to.” Grandma sounded almost amused. “Every Islamic bank and every Islamic fund keeps a **Shariah board** — qualified scholars who work like match referees, inspecting each product long before it reaches you. And there is a neat habit built on top of it. If a tiny drop of impure income ever slips into an approved company, investors give that exact drop away to charity.”

A WORD WITH A LOVELY PICTURE INSIDE IT

Purification — handing away any small impure portion of an income, the way you rinse fruit before eating it. The fruit is good; the rinse makes certain of it.

WHAT MANAHIL FINALLY UNDERSTOOD ABOUT HER PROMISE

The halal way is not a smaller menu. It is a **cleaner** one. Everything in the rest of this book has already survived those three checks — which means she can earn without ever lying awake about where it came from.

★ MISSION FOUR: UNDERSTAND THE PROMISE YOU MADE

Manahil can now name the exact rule her promise is made of — and, more usefully, explain it to somebody else in under a minute.

YOUR TURN

Retell the farmer story in your own words to someone at home. Then argue it out: why is the second neighbour's deal fair even in a terrible year — and the first neighbour's unfair even in a wonderful one?

8

FOUR HONEST FLAVOURS

Four Ways Money Pays You

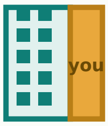
“So money has to work,” said Manahil the next morning, chin on her hands. “But *how* does it work? What does it actually do all day?”

Grandma set four small bowls on the table, one at a time, as though laying out evidence. “In exactly four flavours,” she said. “Taste each one and you will recognise it for the rest of your life.”

1. Profit-share

You hand your money to an Islamic bank as a **partner**. The bank puts it to work in real, permitted trade and splits what it honestly earns with you.

Example: place AED 5,000 for a year → your slice of the profit comes to roughly **AED 500**. The original 100,000 remains entirely yours.



2. Rent

Own something useful — a shop, a slice of a mall, a stretch of motorway — and people pay you regularly for **using** it.

Example: your slice of a plaza sends **AED 45** of rent every month while you are asleep.

3. Dividends

Own a **share** — a real sliver of a real company — and when that company earns a profit, it posts a portion to every owner. That posted cash is a dividend.

Example: you own 200 shares; the company pays AED 15 per share → **AED 150** arrives. You still own all 200 shares afterwards.

4. Capital gains

Buy something, wait while it becomes more valuable, sell it for more than you paid. The difference is your **capital gain**.

Example: buy a share at AED 100, sell later at AED 140 → a gain of **AED 40**. Careful, though: prices also fall. Sell at AED 80 and that is a capital *loss* of AED 20. Chapter 18 is entirely about staying safe.

GRANDMA EXPLAINS IT WITH CRICKET, BECAUSE OF COURSE SHE DOES

Profit-share is your **singles** — steady, low drama. Rent is **twos** — regular and reliable. Dividends are **boundaries**, a fine reward for holding your ground. Capital gains are **sixes**: thrilling, and the fastest way to lose your wicket if you swing at everything. A great innings uses all four. Protecting your capital is simply *not getting out*.

Manahil noticed something and said it out loud. “Three of them pay me while I keep the thing. Only the last one makes me sell it.”

Grandma looked at her for a long moment. “It took your grandfather until he was forty to notice that,” she said. “Write it down.”

FROM MANAHIL'S GREEN NOTEBOOK

Rent, profit-share and dividends arrive while I still own the thing. A capital gain only becomes real money when I let the thing go. So the first three feed me — and the fourth one is the tree itself getting taller.

★ MISSION FIVE: LEARN HOW MONEY PAYS

Four flavours identified, understood and separated. Manahil now knows what she is shopping for — and the next part hands her the shelves.

YOUR TURN

Which flavour would you most like your money to pay you first, and why? There is no wrong answer here — but there is an interesting argument, so have it with someone.

III

PART THREE

Seven Homes and One Fence

With the rule understood, Manahil goes shopping — not for things, but for places a dirham is allowed to live. Seven of them, and one fence around the lot.

WHAT MANAHIL WORKS OUT HERE

✓ Bank partnerships, Sukuk certificates, company shares, funds, gold, property, and a business of her own.

✓ How to read any home's three numbers: what it grows, how much it wobbles, how fast it turns back into cash.

✓ The seven traps that never get through the gate — and exactly why each one fails.

9

HOME ONE — THE BASE CAMP

Islamic Bank Accounts & Term Deposits

Monday after school, Mum drove Manahil to the Islamic bank on the main road, and Manahil wore her good shoes for no reason she could explain.

The Emirates are full of them: **Dubai Islamic Bank**, the world's first full-service Islamic bank, plus **Abu Dhabi Islamic Bank**, **Emirates Islamic**, **Sharjah Islamic Bank** and **Ajman Bank**. All answer to the Central Bank of the UAE and its **Higher Shariah Authority**.

The woman at the counter had a badge that read *Ms Amna*. She did not talk to Mom over Manahil's head, the way adults sometimes do. She shook Manahil's hand like a customer's and asked what she planned to do with the money.

“Grow it,” said Manahil. “Cleanly.”

“Then you have walked into the right building,” said Ms Amna.

Here is what she explained, and what Manahil wrote down afterwards in the car. An Islamic savings account pays no interest, because interest is riba and riba is the first thing the promise forbids. The bank becomes a working partner instead: you bring the money, the bank brings the work — financing genuine trade, vehicles, houses, machinery — and whatever is honestly earned gets split by a ratio agreed in advance, perhaps sixty parts to you and forty to the bank.

THE NAME OF THE PARTNERSHIP

Mudarabah — one side supplies the money, the other supplies the effort, and both agree how to divide the profit *before* anything begins. Nobody promises a fixed reward, because nobody can promise the weather.

Ask for a Mudarabah savings account or an **investment deposit**; the profit rate is *expected*, never promised. If the bank has a poor year, your share is smaller — which is exactly why it is permitted.

“And if the bank has a poor year?” Manahil asked.

“Then your share is smaller,” said Ms Amna. “That is precisely why it is permitted. A profit you share is honest. A profit you are guaranteed is somebody else's problem, dressed up as yours.”

There was a second door too. Promise the money for a longer stretch — one year, three, five — and the bank can plan larger things with it, so your share improves. That is a **term deposit**.

FRUIT IT GROWS	BOUNCE (RISK)	SPEED TO CASH
Profit-share, paid monthly or at the end	1 of 5	**Fast for savings · Medium for a term**

WHY EVERY GARDEN STARTS ON THIS PATCH OF SOIL

Money here barely wobbles, arrives with a profit share attached, and can be reached in a hurry when something goes wrong. Dull? Gloriously. Every serious investor on earth keeps a calm base camp before climbing anywhere.

★ MISSION SIX: OPEN THE BASE CAMP

Account opened, in her own name, with Mom as guardian. The hundred thousand had somewhere safe to sleep — and Manahil walked out of that building two inches taller.

YOUR TURN

In a Mudarabah partnership, who brings the money and who brings the work? And why does a three-year deposit usually share more profit than an everyday account?

10

HOME TWO — A SLICE OF A ROAD

Sukuk: The Halal Certificate

They took the motorway to Aunt Farah's house, and somewhere past the second toll plaza Manahil pressed her nose to the window and asked who owned a road this enormous.

“Would you believe,” said Grandma from the front seat, “that families like ours can own a slice of it?”

Manahil did not believe it, said so, and was told a story about a certificate.

Grown-ups, Grandma explained, often lend money to governments and large companies through something called a **bond**, which pays a fixed rate of interest. Interest is riba. Riba is out. So the door marked *bonds* is closed to Manahil — and the halal world built a smarter door beside it.

A **Sukuk** certificate does not lend anybody anything. It makes you a genuine part-owner of a real asset: a length of motorway, an airport terminal, a power station. The government or company then *uses* that asset and pays you your share of the rent for it.

“So I'm not a lender,” said Manahil slowly. “I'm a landlord.”

“A very small landlord,” agreed Grandma, “of a very large road.”

How this feels in real life

The Emirates made this unusually easy. **Retail sukuk** are listed on **Nasdaq Dubai** and bought through the DFM app with an Emirates ID, in denominations from **AED 1,000**. Profit is paid at set dates — a sukuk with a 5% profit rate pays AED 250 a year on AED 5,000 — and you may sell before maturity if you need the money back.

The federal government and the Dubai and Abu Dhabi governments all issue sukuk, and Islamic banks such as DIB arrange them for customers. Real asset, real use, real rent.

FRUIT IT GROWS	BOUNCE (RISK)	SPEED TO CASH
Rent, paid on a schedule		**Medium — tradeable, or wait until maturity**

THE HALAL COUSIN OF A BOND

Sukuk — certificates of ownership in real assets. The owner earns the asset's rent or profit, never interest on a loan. Steadier than shares, livelier than a savings account.

Real asset. Real use. Real rent. Manahil underlined all three, and for the rest of the journey she looked at the road differently — as a thing that belonged to somebody, and could one day belong a little to her.

YOUR TURN

A bond pays interest on a loan. Explain to somebody at dinner what a Sukuk owner earns instead — and where that money actually comes from.

HOME THREE — OWNING THE KETCHUP

11 Halal Shares on DFM & ADX

At breakfast, Manahil read the toothpaste tube the way a detective reads a crime scene.

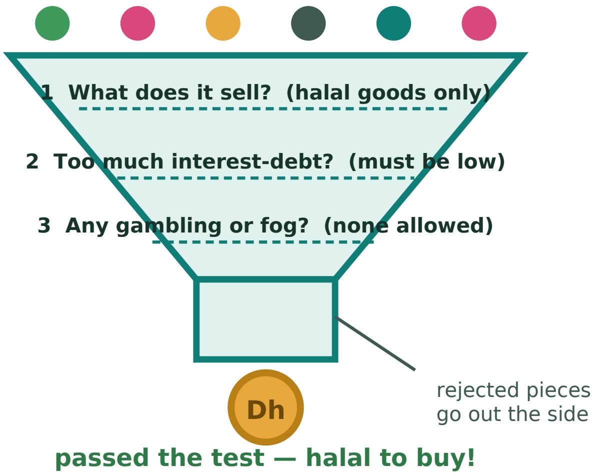
"Grandma. Ordinary people *own* pieces of this company?"

"They do. Even twelve-year-olds, through their parents." Grandma buttered her toast. "Look around this table. The milk, the cement in that wall, the motorbike outside, half the banks in the country. Somebody owns slivers of all of it, and that somebody is usually a perfectly ordinary person."

The marketplace where those slivers change hands is the **Dubai Financial Market** and the **Abu Dhabi Securities Exchange**. Own a share and you are a real part-owner of a real business: dividends arrive when profits are shared, and if the business becomes more valuable, so does your sliver.

Then Manahil remembered the promise, and her face fell. "But not every company can come in. How would I even know?"

"Ah," said Grandma. "That is the beautiful part. Somebody has already done the hard work for you."



Scholars screen every company. Only the clean ones reach the basket.

Each company must pass through a filter with three gates: what it sells must be permitted; its interest-bearing debt must be low; and there must be no gambling and no fog in how it earns. Companies that fail drop out of the side.

Better still, nobody expects a twelve-year-old to run that filter herself. DFM publishes its own **Shariah-compliant share list**, screened by its Fatwa and Shariah Supervisory Board, and global providers such as FTSE Shariah and Dow Jones Islamic Market do the same job for world markets. The lists are re-examined regularly, because businesses change.

SO WHY DO SHARE PRICES JUMP ABOUT?

A price is simply the last deal two strangers agreed on. When more people want to buy than to sell, it climbs; when more want out, it slides. News moves feelings, and feelings move prices *daily* — while the real value of a business grows *yearly*. That single mismatch explains almost every mistake investors make.

FRUIT IT GROWS	BOUNCE (RISK)	SPEED TO CASH
Dividends + capital gains		**Fast — sell on any market day**

THE LINE MANAHIL REPEATED TO HER CLASS LATER THAT TERM

A share is not a lottery ticket and not a number on a screen. It is **part-ownership of a real, permitted business**. Buy businesses, not tickers — and only ones you could explain to a younger cousin without cheating.

★ MISSION SEVEN: THINK LIKE AN OWNER

Manahil picked one company from the screened list whose products were already in her own kitchen, and studied it properly before ever thinking about buying. Worksheet 6 is that study, ready for you.

YOUR TURN

Pick one thing you used today — toothpaste, milk, the family motorbike. With a grown-up, find out whether that company is listed on DFM or ADX and whether it passes the Shariah screen. Prepare to be amazed by how much of daily life belongs to shareholders.

HOME FOUR — THE SHARED BASKET

12 Islamic Mutual Funds & ETFs

Sara counted her pocket money twice, laid it out on the step, and delivered her verdict with tremendous drama.

“This is all I have. All of it! I cannot buy thirty companies with this. I cannot buy the *corner* of one company with this.”

“Alone, no,” agreed Grandma. “Together with a thousand other families?” She let the sentence hang there until both girls leaned in.

A **mutual fund** is one enormous basket. Thousands of families put money in; a professional manager buys a wide, careful mix for all of them at once. In an Islamic fund there is a second guardian standing beside the first: a Shariah advisor who checks every choice against the same three rules Manahil had learned on the veranda.

One basket, two guardians

The **fund manager** chooses the mix and watches it daily. The **Shariah advisor** inspects each pick for the three checks. Neither can overrule the other into carelessness.

Baskets come in three flavours: a **money-market fund** (a still pond, very steady), an **income or Sukuk fund** (a gentle stream of rent), and an **equity fund** (a lively river of screened shares — bigger waves, bigger possibilities).

Two things delighted Sara. First, entry is small: **National Bonds** — a Shariah-compliant savings company regulated by the Securities and Commodities Authority, which invests under a Mudarabah and shares the profit — starts from a few hundred dirhams and runs a junior plan, **Eyaali**, built for children. Second, Islamic funds and screened ETFs are available through UAE banks and brokers, so one purchase can hold dozens of filtered companies.

FRUIT IT GROWS	BOUNCE (RISK)	SPEED TO CASH
Profit, rent or dividends, depending on flavour		**Fast — units usually cash out in days**

THE COMPARISON THAT MADE SARA SIT UP

A fund is a set of training wheels that never insults you. Billionaires use them. Let experienced hands steer while you learn the roads — and take the wheel yourself later, for a small part of the journey, when you actually know where you are going.

Sara put her five hundred dirhams back in her pocket with something new in her face. Not disappointment. Ambition.

YOUR TURN

Name the two guardians of an Islamic fund and say what each one guards. Then choose: which flavour of basket suits money you might need next year — and why not the exciting one?

13

HOME FIVE — THE SHIELD

Gold, Silver & the World of Commodities

At the wedding, the aunts' bangles chimed like tiny bells every time anybody laughed, which was often.

“Grandma,” Manahil whispered between courses, “why does every family keep gold?”

“Because gold saved families when paper money failed,” said Grandma, without looking up. “Ask anyone old enough to have watched it happen.”

Gold belongs to a family of investments called **commodities** — the real, touchable stuff the world runs on. Metals: gold, silver, copper. Crops: wheat, cotton. Energy: oil and gas. Farmers and factories trade them in bulk every day of the week.

For a young investor, though, only one corner of that world is sensible.

How a young person actually invests here

Physical gold or silver — coins or small bars from the **Dubai Gold Souk** or a DMCC-approved dealer, bought at the full price, taken into real possession, stored safely. Those three conditions are what keep the purchase permitted; paper promises and lucky-draw gold games are not.

And a warning from every sensible aunt in the country: jewellery carries heavy making charges you never get back. Beautiful for wearing, poor for investing. **Coins and bars for the tree; bangles for the heart.**

Then Grandma said the honest part, the part salesmen leave out.

“Gold grows nothing. No profit share, no rent, no dividend. It simply sits there looking magnificent.”

Manahil frowned. “Then why keep any at all?”

“Because when inflation attacks the dirham, gold tends to stand its ground. It is not a fruit tree, my dear. It is a **shield** — and a shield is worth carrying even in the years nobody swings at you.”

FRUIT IT GROWS	BOUNCE (RISK)	SPEED TO CASH
No fruit — capital gains only (the shield)		**Fast — the gold souk buys any day**

FROM MANAHIL'S GREEN NOTEBOOK

Gold pays me nothing and I still want a small slice, because it protects everything else when prices run wild. A small slice. Never the whole plan.

YOUR TURN

Why are coins and bars better than bangles for *investing*? And if gold pays no rent and no dividend, what job is it actually doing inside a collection?

14 Property & REITs: Earning Rent Like a Landlord

At the shopping mall, Sara threw both arms wide beside the fountains and announced that one day she would own the entire building.

“You can own a slice of one next month,” said Grandma, sipping her tea, entirely unbothered by the fountains. “Every shop here pays rent to somebody. Explain to me why a little of it should never reach you.”

Every family gathering eventually arrives at the same topic: property. Land and buildings are classic permitted assets — they grow the two calmest fruits there are, **rent** and slow **capital gains**. There is only one difficulty for a twelve-year-old. A building costs millions, and she had a small seed and homework.

Property is the Emirates' favourite conversation, and it slices neatly here: **Emirates REIT**, listed on Nasdaq Dubai, is a Shariah-compliant real estate trust, and other listed funds hold offices, schools and shops. Rent collected is passed to unit-holders; your guardian confirms the Shariah documents of each one.

The pocket-sized door into property: the REIT

A **REIT** — Real Estate Investment Trust — takes one giant building, a mall or a tower, slices its ownership into thousands of small units, and lists those units on the exchange. Buy units and you own a genuine slice; the rent collected is paid out to you regularly, rather like a dividend.

Example: **AED 1,000** of units in a busy shopping centre means every shopper walking past those shops is, in a tiny way, working for your tree. Your grown-up confirms each one before a dirham moves.

FRUIT IT GROWS	BOUNCE (RISK)	SPEED TO CASH
Rent payouts + slow capital gains		**Units: fast · Actual plots: very slow**

THE IDEA THAT SHRINKS A TOWER TO POCKET SIZE

You do not need millions to become a landlord, because **ownership can be sliced**. Rent is the friendliest fruit in the whole book: real people, using real space, paying you for it, month after unglamorous month.

Sara lowered her arms, thought for a while, and said, “So I could own the *corner* of the fountain.”

“The corner of the fountain,” Grandma agreed, “is where everybody starts.”

YOUR TURN

Your family has AED 1,000 — nowhere near enough for a plot of land. Explain how it could still earn property rent this year.

15

HOME SEVEN — THE OLDEST ONE

Your Own Little Business

Saturday, seven in the morning. Flour on the counter, flour on the floor, flour on Motu, who had walked through it and now left small white paw prints across the entire ground floor.

The stall opened at nine: a folding table at the end of the street, a hand-painted sign, and twenty boxes of brownies made from a recipe Manahil had tested three times that week on unpaid volunteers, mostly cousins.

Two girls, one folding table, and the oldest permitted investment on earth.

This last home, Grandma had told them, is the one the Prophet himself practised as a young trader: **honest business**. Make or buy something genuinely useful, sell it at a fair price, keep the difference.

By late afternoon the cash box was heavier than both school bags together. They counted it twice on the kitchen floor.

What we spent — flour, eggs, chocolate, boxes	**AED 100**
What we sold — 20 boxes at AED 9 each	**AED 180**
Profit — one Saturday's work	**AED 80** — a 75% return in a day

“Seventy-five out of every hundred, in one day,” said Sara, star-struck. “No bank on earth pays that. Why are we doing anything else?”

“Because of next Saturday,” said Grandma.

Next Saturday it rained. The street stayed empty. Three boxes sold, and the girls ate more of the stock than they should have, sitting under the folded table watching water run down the road.

“*That* is business,” said Grandma, when they came home damp and quiet. “The highest possible fruit, the highest possible wobble, and the finest teacher any of us ever meet. Every dirham you make here teaches you ten things about every other home in this book.”

FRUIT IT GROWS	BOUNCE (RISK)	SPEED TO CASH
Pure profit — when it works	🌱🌱🌱🌱🌱	**Slow — the money lives inside the business**

★ MISSION EIGHT: EARN THE FIRST RUPEE YOURSELF

A real venture, planned on paper, run twice, profitable once — and a rainy-day lesson worth more than the profit. Manahil now understands risk with her hands, not just her head.

YOUR TURN

Take a small sum from your fruit — never the trunk — and run one tiny weekend venture: baking, bookmarks, an hour of tuition for a younger cousin, something you make and sell through a parent's account online. Plan it on Worksheet 3 and write down every dirham in and out. Either way you win: profit, or a lesson cheaper than any business school.

16

THE FENCE

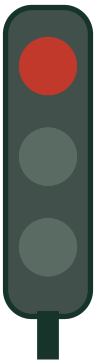
The Red-Light List: What You Skip

The voice note arrived on Mom's phone from a distant aunt, and it was very excited.

“Guaranteed! Double your money in two months! Everybody is joining! Last chance, it closes tonight!”

Grandma listened to the whole thing once, without expression. Then she set the phone face down on the table and said, quietly, “Girls. Sit. It is time you learned the list.”

A good gardener knows the weeds by name. Everything below stays **outside** the fence — and each one fails at least one of the three checks from chapter seven. Knowing *why* is what makes a person impossible to fool.



FAILS CHECK ONE — IT BREEDS RIBA (MONEY PAID FOR NO WORK AND NO SHARED RISK)

Interest accounts, bonds and savings certificates

They hand over a fixed extra on lent money in every weather — riba, the first neighbour's deal from chapter seven, where the lender cannot lose. A permitted cousin exists for each one: an Islamic account in place of an interest account, Sukuk in place of bonds.

Lending to a friend for a profit

“Return my thousand as eleven hundred” makes money multiply with no work done and no risk shared — exactly what the fairness test forbids. Lending to *help* is beautiful; then a thousand simply comes back as a thousand.

FAILS CHECK TWO — THE BUSINESS ITSELF IS FORBIDDEN

Companies selling what harms people

Alcohol, pork, gambling apps, indecent entertainment. A share makes you a **part-owner**, so their earnings would quietly become your earnings. However large the profit, a clean collection owns no harm.

Famous names that fail the screen

However tempting the price or beloved the brand — too much interest-bearing debt, or money arriving from forbidden corners — if it is missing from the screened list, it does not come in. The filter *is* the fence.

FAILS CHECK THREE — GAMBLING AND FOG (MAYSIR AND GHARAR)

Prize bonds, lotteries and betting

A lucky draw creates nothing at all: one person wins *only because* many others lose, which is maysir. Most scholars add that prize bonds braid a lottery together with interest. Excitement, certainly. Honest earning, no.

Ordinary insurance — the kind that is not Takaful

You pay for a promise wrapped in fog, an uncertain bargain (gharar) whose pooled money usually sits earning interest. The permitted answer waits in chapter 18: **Takaful**, families protecting families, with risk genuinely shared.

Foggy coins and pyramid schemes

Prices that double and collapse inside a week, backed by nothing anybody can touch or explain; and “plans” that pay old members using new members' money until — suddenly — nothing. Trees do not grow in fog. Park your curiosity there. Never your capital.

THE SHIELD — READ THIS ONE TWICE

One day, and this is a promise rather than a warning, somebody will offer you a guaranteed way to double your money quickly. A committee that never fails. A scheme an aunt's friend swears by. A message about a golden chance closing tonight.

Real investing grows like a tree. Tricks promise a rocket. Guaranteed plus big plus fast equals trap, every single time, without exception. Say no, keep your money, tell a grown-up. Wealthy people are not the ones who never meet these offers — they are the ones who recognise them.

“If the return sounds like magic, my dear, then the trick is on you.”

— GRANDMA

Manahil copied the formula onto the inside cover of the green notebook, where she would see it every time she opened it. Two months later, that page saved her best friend — but that is chapter nineteen.

YOUR TURN

A lottery ticket pays out AED 5,000. Which check did it fail — and why is the win still not honest earning? Then say the trap formula from memory and name your two moves.

IV

PART FOUR

The Long Game

The homes are chosen. Now Manahil learns the four powers that decide whether a seed becomes an orchard — and the plan that turns a story into her real life.

WHAT MANAHIL WORKS OUT HERE

- ✓ Compounding, and the one piece of arithmetic worth memorising.
- ✓ Spreading the risk, and why a shield beats a lucky guess.
- ✓ Guarding digital money — the rule that rescued her best friend.
- ✓ Zakat, sadaqah, and the partnership that brings blessing.
- ✓ Five stepping stones from this page into the real world.

THE QUIET SUPERPOWER

17 Compounding: Fruit That Grows Its Own Trees

Grandma pinned two photographs to the fridge, side by side, and waited to be asked.

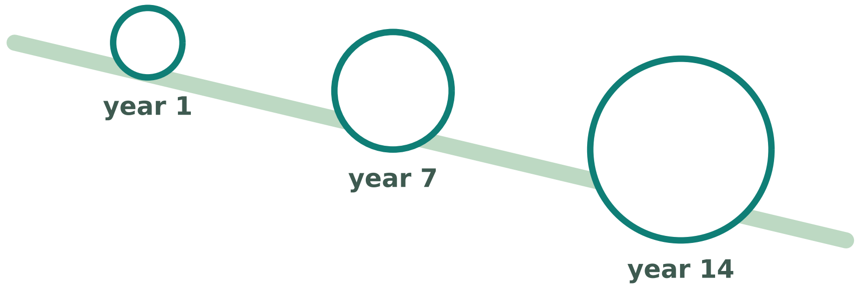
The first showed a stick with three leaves on it, standing in a bare corner of the courtyard. The second showed the mango tree as it stands today, taller than the roof, wide enough to shade the whole wall.

“Nobody believed in the stick,” said Grandma. “Not one visitor. Trees are slow… and then, quite suddenly, they are not.”

The idea behind both photographs is the most powerful in all of money, and it fits in a single line.

Do not eat all the fruit. Plant some of it.

When earnings are put back to work, those earnings start earning too. Fruit becomes saplings; saplings grow fruit of their own; and one morning you look up and you do not have a tree any more. You have an orchard.

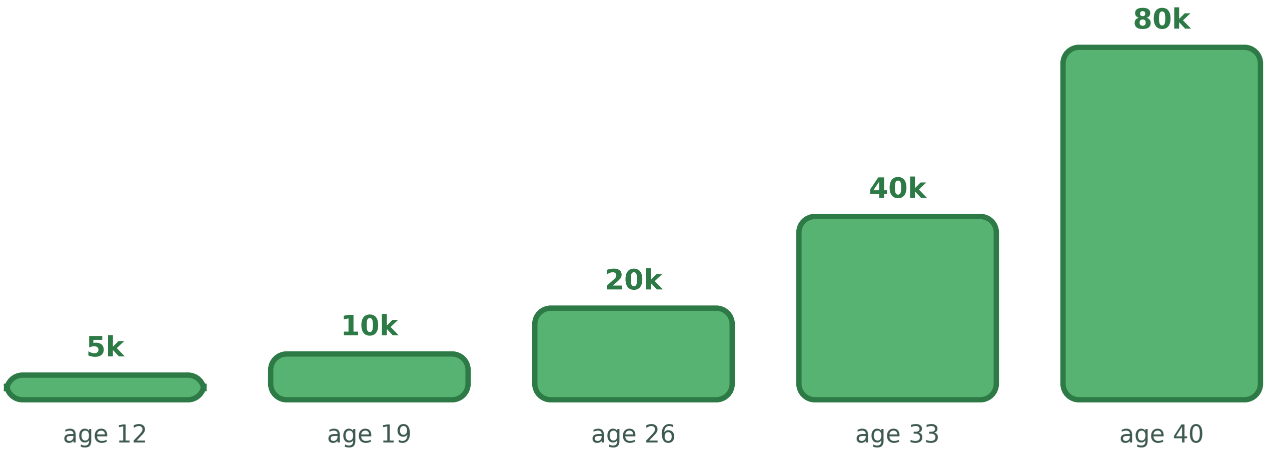


A snowball rolling downhill collects snow — and the larger it grows, the faster it collects.

THE ONE PIECE OF ARITHMETIC WORTH MEMORISING: THE RULE OF 72

How long until money doubles? Divide 72 by the yearly return. At ten per cent: 72 ÷ 10 ≈ **7 years to double**. That is the only formula in this entire book, and it fits on a bus ticket.

Manahil ran the rule forward on her own five thousand dirhams, at the example rate, with every dirham of fruit replanted. Then she ran it again because the answer looked wrong.



A steady 10% a year, everything replanted. Real life wobbles — but this is the shape of it.

There it was, drawn as a staircase: by forty, the seed alone could be worth around **AED 80,000** — **without her adding a single extra dirham**. And Grandma showed her the second staircase, the one that matters more: add AED 100 of your own every month once you are earning, keep replanting, and the same arithmetic carries you past your first AED 500,000 and on toward that million. She had planted once. Time did the lifting; habit does the rest.

WHY TWELVE IS SUCH A RIDICULOUS ADVANTAGE

Compounding's closest friend is **time** — and time is the one thing you own more of than every adult you know. Beginning at twelve instead of thirty is not a head start. It is a different life entirely.

FROM MANAHIL'S GREEN NOTEBOOK

Eating all the fruit every year keeps the orchard exactly one tree wide, forever. Replanting half is how a stick becomes a roof-high tree while you are busy growing up.

YOUR TURN

At eight per cent a year, how long does money take to double? Use the rule. Then explain, in tree language, why an impatient investor stays small.

18 NEVER ONE BASKET

Eggs, Baskets & the Risk Seesaw

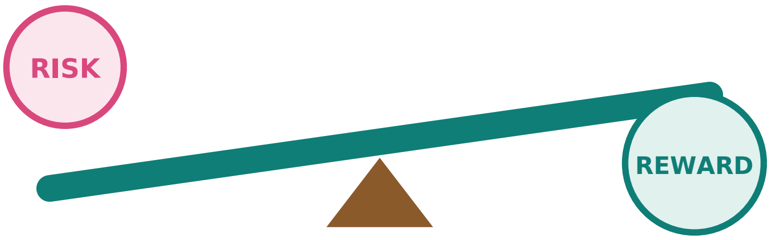
At the bazaar, a porter lost his grip and an entire tray of eggs met the ground at once.

Sara gasped loudly enough to turn heads. “*All* of them!”

Grandma did not even break step. She raised one eyebrow at the girls and said, “And that is today's entire lesson. One basket. Never again.”

It was time to be honest about the frightening word. **Risk** is simply the chance that things do not go to plan: a share slides, a rainy Saturday empties a brownie stall, a certainty turns out not to be one. Every home in part three came with a wobble rating, and behind all of them sits a single law.

they always ride together



Reward and risk are bolted to the same plank. Lift one and the other rises.

Larger possible rewards always travel with larger possible falls. Anyone offering an enormous reward at zero risk is confused or lying, and chapter sixteen has already dealt with the liars.

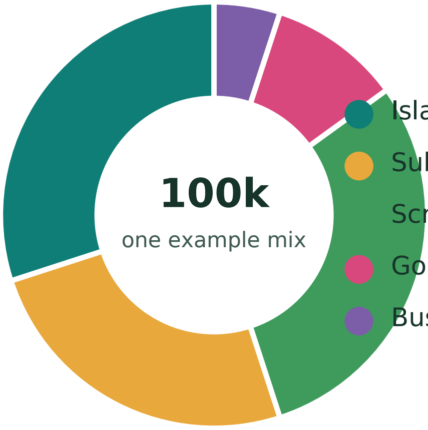
So how do careful investors sleep? With the oldest trick in the book: never carry every egg in one basket. Ten eggs, one basket, one stumble — breakfast is over. Spread across several, and a stumble costs a single egg.

TWO WORDS THAT BUY A GOOD NIGHT'S SLEEP

Diversification — spreading money across different homes so that no single bad day can truly hurt you. Investing's seatbelt.

Liquidity — how quickly something turns back into spendable cash. Savings: days. Shares and REIT units: market days. Plots and businesses: months. A sensible plan always keeps something fast for emergencies.

Then Grandma sketched what a spread-out five thousand dirhams might look like — one example, she stressed, and not a prescription, because the real one is shaped by a family and its advisor.



Islamic savings & money-market fund — 30%	**AED 1,500**
Sukuk & Islamic income funds — 25%	**AED 1,250**
Screened shares & equity funds — 30%	**AED 1,500**
Gold coins — 10%	**AED 500**
Business & learning pocket — 5%	**AED 250**

One example mix — your family and advisor shape the real one.

“See the logic?” said Grandma. “The calm homes form the base, keeping the scoreboard ticking. A strong slice chases the boundaries. Gold guards against inflation. And if shares have a miserable year, most of the tree stands untouched.”

ONE MORE SHIELD: TAKAFUL

Grown-ups also protect a household with **Takaful**: many families pool money so that whoever meets trouble — illness, accident, fire — is helped by everyone. The Emirates has a proper Takaful industry — names such as Salama, Takaful Emarat and Dubai Islamic Insurance — regulated alongside the banks.

THE SENTENCE NOBODY WANTS TO SAY OUT LOUD

Risk cannot be removed — only chosen carefully and spread thin. Diversification means never having to begin a sentence with the saddest words in money: *“it was all in that one thing…”*

YOUR TURN

Why does the example mix keep almost a third in calm homes instead of putting everything into exciting shares? And which slice would you reach for first in an emergency?

19

THE NIGHT SHE SAVED HER FRIEND

Digital Money & Staying Safe Online

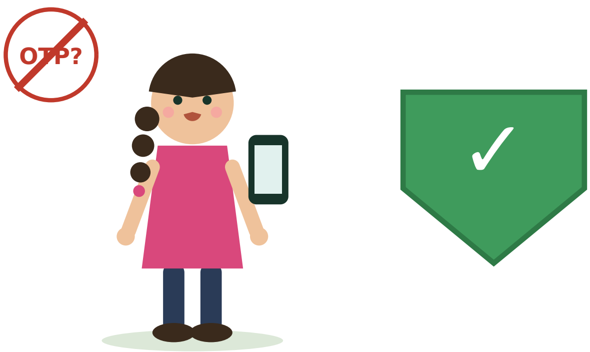
Sara's phone rang on a Tuesday at ten past seven, and the voice on the other end was the friendliest voice either girl had ever heard.

“Congratulations! Your number has won a scooter in our lucky draw! I only need the little code we have just sent to your phone, and delivery is tomorrow—”

Sara's thumb was already moving toward the message. Manahil crossed the room in three steps and caught her wrist.

“Sara. **No.** The shield.”

The line went dead. The room went quiet. Two hearts hammered, and one scooter, which had never existed anywhere except in a stranger's script, quietly failed to arrive.



The bank guards the vault. You guard the keys.

Most dirhams today are **digital** — numbers guarded by passwords, moving between bank apps, cards and wallets. Digital money is wonderful: it is fast, it counts itself, and it cannot fall out of a pocket. But it changes who thieves attack. Online thieves almost never break into banks. They talk people into opening the door from the inside.

OTP, PIN, password: three keys, all yours, shared with nobody.

THE FOUR RULES, RECITED LIKE TIMES TABLES

1. Never share a PIN, password or OTP with anyone — not callers, not messages, not somebody claiming to be from the bank. Real banks never ask. **Whoever asks is the thief.**

2. Use official apps only, installed with a grown-up watching.

3. Show a grown-up before paying anyone online. Every time.

4. If a call or message rushes you or frightens you, end it and tell an adult. Urgency is the oldest tool in the box.

Grandma made them learn the three classic tricks by name, so that no trick would ever get to introduce itself first.

The prize call

“You have won! Simply pay a small fee or tax first…” You entered no draw. Winners never pay to collect. End the call.

The scare call

“Your account will be blocked within the hour! Read me the code we just sent to save it.” That code is the key to the money. Sharing it hands over the account. Hang up, tell a grown-up, and let them ring the bank's own published number.

The too-good bargain

A brand-new phone at half price, but “transfer by wallet first, the courier leaves today.” You pay; the seller evaporates. When a deal is far too good, it is not a deal. It is bait.

WHAT MANAHIL UNDERSTOOD WHILE HER HANDS WERE STILL SHAKING

In digital money, **you are the lock**. A secret kept is a door closed; a secret shared is a door opened. And notice the family resemblance: the “double your money” message from chapter sixteen is the same rocket, wearing a new costume.

★ MISSION NINE: GUARD THE KEYS

Manahil recognised a trap in real time and stopped it — the first time anything she read in the green notebook rescued somebody. Sara now recites the four rules faster than she does.

YOUR TURN

Act it out at home: one of you is the scare-caller, the other defends. Then swap. What exact words will you use to end that call politely and firmly — before you ever need them?

20

THE FRUIT SHE GAVE AWAY

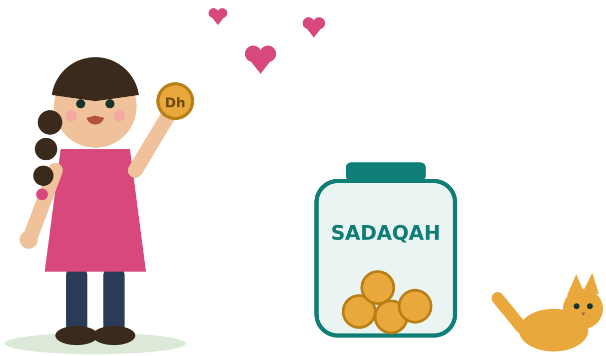
Zakat & Sadaqah: The Fruit You Give

On the last Friday of the month, Grandma took both girls — and a small, heavy cloth bag — to the shelter behind the mosque.

Nobody there knew their names. Nothing was announced. They handed the bag to a quiet man at the door, drank the tea he insisted on, and walked home in the warm evening.

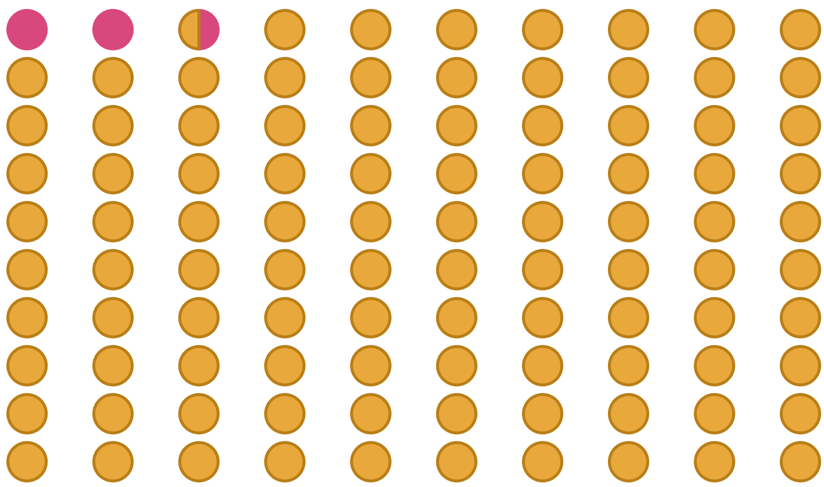
Manahil could not explain it in the notebook that night, but she tried: she felt somehow *richer* walking home than she had walking there.

“That feeling,” said Grandma, “is where barakah begins.”



The lightest bag either of them had ever carried home.

One more thing makes wealth truly clean, and it is not an investment at all. It is a gift. Each year, a Muslim whose savings stay above a certain line — the **nisab** — gives about two and a half out of every hundred of that saved wealth to those in need. This is **Zakat**, the third pillar of Islam, and Grandma called it the proudest duty a future millionaire has.



Zakat: roughly two and a half coins out of every hundred saved, counted once a year.

On a five thousand dirhams that comes to roughly **AED 125** a year — the exact sum, dates and nisab are worked out by grown-ups. Could the tree afford it? Easily. The example fruit was about **AED 500**; Zakat took 2,500 and left plenty to replant and enjoy.

The Emirates has the **Zakat Fund** for exactly this, and bodies such as the Emirates Red Crescent and Dubai Charity receive both Zakat and sadaqah. Your family chooses the channel; the duty stays the same.

“Now,” said Grandma, “learn the difference between Zakat and its younger, free-spirited cousin. People confuse the two constantly, and they are not the same thing at all.”

ZAKAT — THE DUTY

A pillar of Islam. About 2.5% of saved wealth above the nisab, once every year, calculated.

It **purifies** the wealth you keep.

SADAQAH — THE GIFT

Entirely your choice: any amount, any day — and best of all, a promised slice of **every income** your money earns.

It invites **barakah** on the wealth you grow.

Then Grandma taught them the habit she said had shaped her whole life: promise a fixed share of **every income** your money brings you — every profit share, every rent, every dividend — to those in need, before a single dirham of it is spent. Five out of a hundred, ten, whatever number you can honestly keep every single time.

MAKE ALLAH A PARTNER IN YOUR WEALTH

That promised **sadaqah** from every earning is a partnership. Scholars describe it beautifully: you have made **Allah a partner in your wealth** — and no partner is more generous. Sadaqah does not shrink what you own; it invites **barakah**, divine blessing: unseen goodness, protection and growth that no calculator can measure.

“Give sadaqah from every fruit, my dear. A garden that feeds others is a garden Allah Himself looks after.”

— GRANDMA

TWO GIFTS, TWO DIFFERENT JOBS

Zakat purifies the wealth you keep. **Sadaqah partners** the income you earn. Together they water an entire neighbourhood — while your own tree carries on growing.

★ MISSION TEN: TAKE THE MOST GENEROUS PARTNER THERE IS

Manahil set her share that night and wrote it into the notebook as a standing order, not a mood: a fixed slice of every dirham her money ever earns, promised away before it arrives.

YOUR TURN

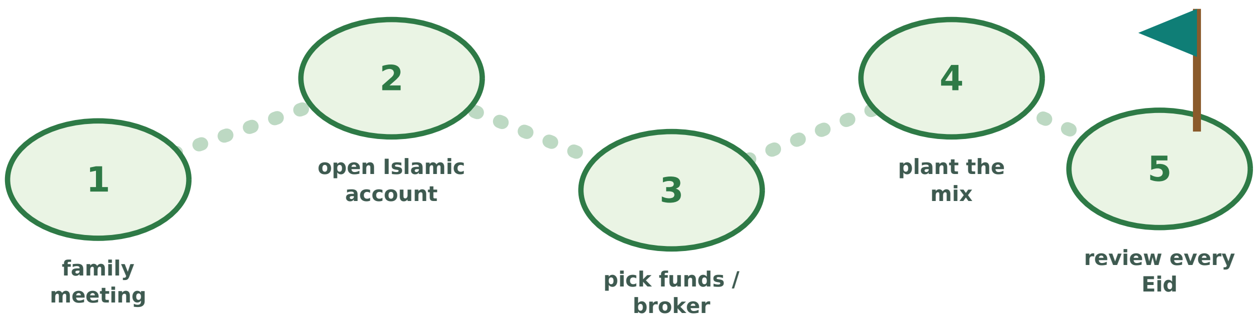
Roughly how much Zakat falls due on AED 10,000 of saved wealth? And say the difference plainly: who decides the amount in each case, and which of the two makes Allah a partner in your wealth?

FROM PAPER INTO THE WORLD

21 Your Launch Plan: Five Steps With a Grown-Up

Sunday night. The big family meeting. The notebook open at a fresh page, Dad on hold with the bank's helpline, and Motu asleep across the middle of the plan.

Manahil wrote the date at the top and underlined it, because this was the evening the story stopped being a story and became a set of instructions.



Five stepping stones from this page into real life.

Stone one — the family meeting. Read the book together. Write three goals on paper: *protect the seed; earn monthly fruit; reach AED 10,000 by nineteen*. Then say the golden rule aloud, all of you, until somebody laughs — eat the fruit, never cut the tree.

Stone two — open the base camp. With a parent or guardian, open a junior account at an Islamic bank using the guardian's Emirates ID and your birth certificate, and start a **National Bonds** plan — the junior Eyaali plan is built for exactly this.

Stone three — open the growing doors. Add retail sukuk through the DFM app (a NIN and Emirates ID are needed), plus Islamic funds through a bank or broker, asking each one: *“Is this Shariah-compliant, and who sits on your Shariah board?”*

Stone four — plant the mix. Move money into the family's own version of the chapter 18 spread; Worksheet 2 is where you design it. Then set the standing rule for every dirham of fruit that ever arrives: **half replanted**, a slice for Zakat plus the promised sadaqah from chapter 20, and the rest enjoyed without a trace of guilt.

Stone five — inspect every Eid. Twice a year, fifteen minutes: What grew? What wobbled? Is every home still on the permitted list? What is one new thing learned? Write it down. Future-you will read page one and be astonished at how small it started.

THE DIARY STARTS TONIGHT

Worksheet 4 is page one. Fill it in today: the date, the amount, the three goals, and one sentence — *“I chose door two, because...”* After that, a single line each month. What the money did, and one thing you learned. Millionaires measure.

★ MISSION ELEVEN: TURN THE BOOK INTO A PLAN

Three goals written, two accounts opened, one mix planted, one standing rule agreed by the whole family. The story now had a spine of real paperwork holding it up.

YOUR TURN

Which two documents open a minor's bank account? And what is the one question you will ask every bank, fund or broker for the rest of your life, before a dirham moves?

22

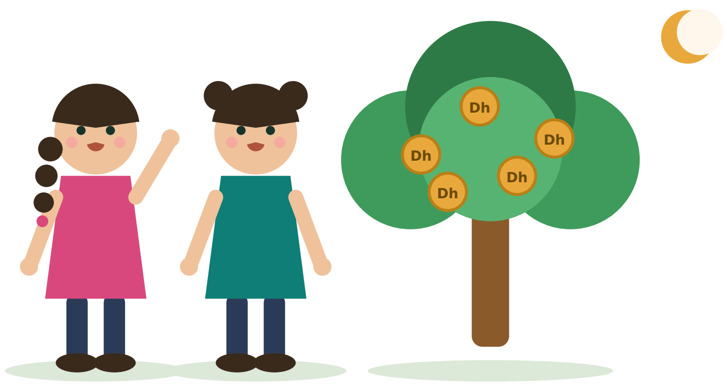
ONE YEAR LATER

Keeping the Crown

Eid morning came around the way it always does — suddenly, and smelling of sweets.

Henna again. New clothes again. Cousins on the stairs again, though taller. Grandma called Manahil over to the chair by the window with the same crooked finger, and this time Manahil was already walking, because she had been waiting for this for twelve months.

She was carrying the green notebook. Sara came behind her holding three jars, all of them heavier than they had been in the spring.



Twelve months of patience, drawn to scale.

"Well," said Grandma. "Two questions. What grew — and how did it stay clean?"

Manahil opened the notebook and read out what she had written that morning.

YEAR ONE — THE REPORT SHE READ ALOUD

The seed	Whole. Never once cut into.
Where it lives	Islamic bank account, Sukuk, screened funds, gold coins, one brownie business.
What it earned	About AED 500 of fruit across the year — roughly AED 40 a month.
What was replanted	Half of every dirham of fruit, without exception.
What was given	Zakat of about AED 2,500, plus the promised sadaqah from every earning.
Traps refused	One guaranteed-double voice note. One prize call. Zero regrets.
Lessons paid for	One rainy Saturday. Cheapest tuition of the year.

Grandma listened to all of it without once interrupting, which was itself a kind of award. Then she asked the only question that mattered.

"And if I had handed you nothing at all this morning — what would you do?"

"Start with the SAVE jar," said Manahil. "The amount was never the point. The habit was." Then, because she was still twelve: "Also, insha'Allah, I would ask for a bigger envelope."

Grandma smiled the way people smile when a plan has worked.

Now look at what nearly happened instead. Two girls, one envelope, two entirely different endings.

UNIVERSE ONE — THE SPENDER

Two thousand treats. A cracked phone.

Money left: **AED 0**

Monthly income: **AED 0**

The seed? **Gone — beginning again from nothing.**

UNIVERSE TWO — THE INVESTOR

Everything planted, cleanly, at about 10%.

Money kept: **AED 5,000** — the tree stands.

Fruit this year: about **AED 500** ≈ AED 40 a month.

The seed? **Whole, and growing — this year and every year.**

Look closely at the second one. Roughly AED 40 of guilt-free treat money every month — ice cream is covered, permanently — Zakat paid with pride, and next Eid the seed still whole. Follow stone four and replant half the fruit, and the tree itself keeps growing, and the monthly fruit keeps growing, and somewhere around forty she passes milestones she once thought belonged to other people entirely — every dirham of it clean.

Same girl. Same envelope. Same country. Two completely different lives — decided by one choice, made at twelve. The age you happen to be right now.

THE WHOLE YEAR IN FOUR LINES

1. Money spent is gone; money planted grows fruit — in four flavours.

2. Only permitted homes get through the gate: the filter is the fence.

3. Eat the fruit, never cut the tree — replant half, give with pride.

4. Start now, spread it out, guard your OTP, ignore rockets, trust time.

“I did not give you money, my dear. I gave you a seed. What you did with it — that part was always yours.”

— GRANDMA

So… which door will you choose?

THE TOOLBOX

For Class & Home

Everything you can photocopy, fill in, argue over and pin to a wall — plus a twelve-week route for teachers, and the certificate waiting with your name on it.

WHAT IS WAITING IN HERE

✓ A one-page map of every home a dirham can live in.

✓ The Big Test, and six worksheets that turn reading into doing.

✓ A pocket dictionary, a find-it-fast index, and the family pledge.

✓ The teacher's twelve-week journey — and Manahil's certificate, ready for you.

THE ONE-PAGE CHEAT SHEET

Manahil's Treasure Map

The pot	Fruit it grows	Bounce	Speed to cash
Islamic savings / term deposit	Profit-share	●○○○○	Fast
Sukuk (govt / company)	Rent	●●○○○	Medium
Islamic money-market fund	Profit	●○○○○	Fast
Islamic income / Sukuk fund	Rent + profit	●●○○○	Fast
Halal equity fund / Islamic ETF	Dividends + gains	●●●○○	Fast
Screened shares on DFM/ADX	Dividends + gains	●●●●○	Fast
Gold & silver coins	Gains only (the shield)	●●●○○	Fast
REIT units	Rent + gains	●●●○○	Fast
Property (plots, shops)	Rent + gains	●●●○○	Very slow
Your own halal business	Pure profit (if it works)	●●●●●	Slow

The standing orders: pass every pot through the three halal checks · eat fruit, never trunk · re-plant half · give Zakat yearly · spread the eggs · keep one fast pot for surprises · guard PIN and OTP like your toothbrush · review every Eid · and if it promises a rocket — run.

FIFTEEN QUESTIONS · ANSWER KEY BELOW

The Big Millionaire Test

1. Your AED 5,000 has a special name — what is it, and what may you never do with it?
2. A company pays AED 12 per share and you own 500 shares. What arrives, and what is it called?
3. Why is Neighbour A's deal (guaranteed AED 120,000 back, rain or drought) not allowed?
4. Name the halal cousin of a bond — and what does its owner actually earn?
5. What two things does the halal filter check before a share may enter your garden?
6. Rule of 72: at 9% a year, how long does money take to double?
7. Why is hiding cash under the mattress for 10 years a losing plan?
8. Gold grows no fruit — so why keep a small slice at all?
9. Your wealth stays above nisab this year. About how much of every 100 dirhams goes to those in need — and what is it called?
10. A neighbour guarantees to double your money in two months. Your two moves?
11. What was barter's double-wish problem — and name money's three jobs today.
12. Split AED 1,000 of pocket money using the three-jar example from Chapter 3.
13. A caller says you won a prize but must first pay AED 5,000 “tax”. Which trick is this, and your move?
14. Someone claiming to be “from the bank” asks for the OTP just sent to your phone. What do you do — and why?
15. Which jar feeds your money tree — and once planted, what is the golden rule?

THE ANSWER KEY — CHECK YOURSELF, THEN LET A GROWN-UP CHECK YOU

1. Your capital — the trunk. Never spend it; spend only its fruit.
2. 500 x AED 12 = AED 6,000 — a dividend. You still keep all 500 shares.
3. He wins no matter what happens — a guaranteed extra on a loan is riba, unfair by design.
4. Sukuk — you own a slice of a real asset and earn its rent, never interest.
5. What the company sells (halal only) and its interest-debt (must be low; no gambling/fog).
6. 72 / 9 = 8 years. (At 12%, just 6!)
7. Inflation — prices keep rising, so money standing still quietly buys less every year.
8. It is the shield: when inflation attacks the dirham, gold's price tends to stand tall.
9. About 2.5 from every 100 — Zakat, the proudest duty of a future millionaire.
10. Say no; tell a grown-up. Guaranteed + big + fast = trick, every time.
11. A trade needed BOTH sides to want the swap. Jobs: swap tool, measuring tape, storage box.
12. One example: AED 50 spend, AED 40 save, AED 10 give — your family may pick its own split.
13. The prize call (advance-fee trick). You never entered; winners never pay. Hang up, tell an adult.
14. Never share it — the OTP IS the key. Real banks never ask; whoever asks is the thief.
15. The SAVE jar. Golden rule: eat the fruit, never cut the tree.

W1

WORKSHEET 1 · PHOTOCOPY ME!

My Three-Jar Plan

Give every dirham a job before spending begins. Fill this in each time money arrives — Eid money, pocket money, brownie profits!

MY NAME & THE DATE

MONEY THAT LANDED IN MY HANDS THIS MONTH (AED)

MY THREE-JAR SPLIT (WRITE THE RUPEES — ANY FAIR SPLIT YOUR FAMILY LIKES)

SPEND	SAVE	GIVE

ONE THING I AM SAVING FOR (AND ITS PRICE)

ONE GIVE IDEA THAT WOULD MAKE ME SMILE

A WANT I WILL HAPPILY WAIT FOR THIS MONTH

W2

WORKSHEET 2 · PHOTOCOPY ME!

My Halal Garden Plan

Design your own AED 5,000 garden. Rule one: every pot must pass the three halal checks. Rule two: no single basket carries all the eggs.

IF I HAD AED 5,000 TODAY, MY THREE GOALS WOULD BE

MY GARDEN MIX — SPLIT YOUR AED 5,000 ACROSS THE POTS (CHECK CHAPTER 18 FOR ONE EXAMPLE)

The pot	%	AED	Why I chose this much
Islamic savings / money-market			
Sukuk & income funds			
Halal shares & equity funds			
Gold & silver coins			
Business & learning pocket			
Total	**100%**	**AED 1,000,000**	

MY RE-PLANTING PROMISE (WHAT SHARE OF EVERY FRUIT GOES BACK INTO THE GARDEN?)

THE QUESTION I WILL ASK EVERY BANK, FUND OR BROKER

W3

WORKSHEET 3 · PHOTOCOPY ME!

My Weekend Business Plan

Plan it like a real trader: know your costs BEFORE you spend, price fairly, and write down what really happened. Fruit money only — never the trunk!

MY BUSINESS IDEA (WHAT WILL I SELL, AND TO WHOM?)

MY COSTS — EVERYTHING I MUST BUY FIRST

Item	AED
Total cost	

MY PRICE PER PIECE — AND HOW MANY I MUST SELL TO COVER MY COSTS

IF IT GOES WRONG (RAIN! NOBODY BUYS!), MY BACKUP PLAN IS

AFTER SELLING DAY — MY SALES, MY PROFIT OR LOSS, AND ONE LESSON

WORKSHEET 4 · PHOTOCOPY ME!

W4

My Money Diary

Millionaires measure. This page starts your diary — copy it into any notebook and keep it going for years.

PAGE ONE · TODAY'S DATE AND MY STARTING AMOUNT

MY THREE GOALS (COPY FROM THE FAMILY MEETING)

MY SENTENCE: "I CHOSE DOOR 2 BECAUSE…"

ONE LINE EVERY MONTH — WHAT MY GARDEN DID · ONE THING I LEARNED

EID REVIEW NOTES (WHAT GREW? WHAT WOBBLED? STILL ALL HALAL?)

WORKSHEET 5 · PHOTOCOPY ME!

W5 Inflation Detective

Chapter 6 says prices climb a little every year. Prove it! Interview a parent or grandparent, fill in the table, and see inflation with your own eyes.

THE GROWN-UP I INTERVIEWED (AND ROUGHLY HOW OLD THEY ARE)

____

ASK THEM: WHAT DID THESE COST WHEN YOU WERE MY AGE? AND TODAY?

Item	Price then	Price now
A loaf of bread		
One litre of milk		
A dozen eggs		
A pair of school shoes		
A bus or taxi ride		

THE PRICE THAT SURPRISED ME MOST — AND BY HOW MUCH IT CLIMBED

____

____

IF PRICES KEEP CLIMBING, WHAT HAPPENS TO MONEY HIDING IN A DRAWER?

____

____

W6

WORKSHEET 6 · PHOTOCOPY ME!

Company Detective: My First Share Study

Chapter 11 says a share is part-ownership of a real business — so study the business like a detective before you'd ever buy a slice of it.

A COMPANY WHOSE THINGS MY FAMILY ALREADY BUYS

WHAT DOES IT SELL? ARE ITS PRODUCTS HALAL GOODS?

ASK A GROWN-UP TO CHECK: IS IT ON THE DFM SHARIAH-COMPLIANT LIST?

THE PRICE OF ONE SHARE TODAY (A GROWN-UP CAN LOOK IT UP)

WHY I THINK PEOPLE WILL STILL WANT ITS PRODUCTS IN TEN YEARS

ONE THING THAT COULD GO WRONG FOR THIS BUSINESS (EVERY BUSINESS HAS ONE)

MY VERDICT: WOULD I WANT TO BE A PART-OWNER? WHY?

YOUR POCKET DICTIONARY

Little Words, Big Money

Asset — something you own that can pay you or grow in value (shares, Sukuk, gold — not burgers).

Amanah — a trust. Wealth is handed to you to look after, not simply to enjoy.

Barakah — divine blessing — unseen goodness that grows in wealth earned cleanly and shared generously.

Barter — swapping things directly — mangoes for shoes. Failed at the double-wish problem.

Budget — a plan that gives every dirham a job before spending begins.

Capital — your original money; the trunk of the tree. Here: your AED 100,000.

Capital gain — profit from selling something for more than you paid.

Commodity — a real, touchable good the world trades in bulk — gold, silver, wheat, cotton, oil.

Compounding — earnings earning their own earnings; fruit growing new trees.

Dividend — cash a company shares with its owners out of its profit.

Diversification — spreading money across baskets so one fall can't break everything.

Halal / Haram — allowed / forbidden. Grandma's condition: only halal earning enters the garden.

Inflation — prices rising over time, shrinking what each dirham buys.

Islamic ETF — a basket copying a screened index, traded on an exchange like one share.

National Bonds — a Shariah-compliant UAE savings company; profit is shared under a Mudarabah, not paid as interest.

Liquidity — how fast an investment turns back into spendable cash.

Mudarabah — a partnership: you bring money, the bank brings work; profits shared by an agreed ratio.

Mutual fund — a big shared basket run by a fund manager — Islamic ones have a Shariah advisor too.

Needs & wants — must-haves for living and learning vs lovely extras. Needs first, wants planned.

Maysir & gharar — gambling and fog: winning by luck, or a deal too murky to understand. Both are out.

Nisab — the wealth line above which Zakat becomes due (grown-ups calculate it).

Opportunity cost — what you give up when you choose something else.

OTP & PIN — the secret keys to digital money. Shared with no one — real banks never ask.

DFM & ADX — the Dubai and Abu Dhabi exchanges — where shares, sukuk and funds are traded.

Purification — giving away any tiny impure income to charity — rinsing the fruit.

REIT — a trust that slices a big building into small units; owners share the rent.

Riba — a guaranteed extra on lent money — interest. Forbidden, because it wins rain or drought.

Rule of 72 — 72 ÷ yearly return % ≈ years for money to double.

Sadaqah — voluntary giving you choose — any amount, from any income; the giving that makes Allah a partner in your wealth.

Shariah board — the scholar-referees who check every Islamic product before it reaches you.

Share — one tiny slice of ownership in a real company.

Central Bank of the UAE — issues the dirham; its Higher Shariah Authority oversees Islamic finance.

Sukuk — certificates of ownership in real assets; you earn the asset's rent or profit.

Takaful — families pooling money to protect whichever member faces trouble — halal insurance.

Zakat — about 2.5% of saved wealth above nisab, given yearly to those in need.

A QUICK INDEX — FIND IT FAST

Which Chapter Has My Answer?

Stuck on something? Real readers ask real questions. Run your finger down the left side, then jump straight to the chapter on the right.

Your question	Where to look
“What exactly makes money halal or not?”	**Chapter 7 — the three checks**
“Why do prices climb every single year?”	**Chapter 6 — inflation**
“Is a bank account halal?”	**Chapter 9 — Mudarabah**
“What is a share, really?”	**Chapter 11 — part-ownership**
“I'm twelve — how do I know what to pick?”	**Chapter 12 — funds do it for you**
“Can I lose money? How do I stay safe?”	**Chapters 16 & 18 — the fence and the seesaw**
“How long until my money doubles?”	**Chapter 17 — the Rule of 72**
“Someone promised guaranteed profit…”	**Chapter 16 — the scam shield**
“A caller is asking for my OTP!”	**Chapter 19 — never share it. Ever.**
“How much Zakat on AED 5,000?”	**Chapter 20 — about AED 125**
“Why give away part of what I earn?”	**Chapter 20 — sadaqah: Allah as your partner**
“Can I really start a business at twelve?”	**Chapter 15 — the brownie experiment**
“Okay, I'm ready. Where do I start?”	**Chapter 21 — the five stones**

THE FASTEST ANSWER OF ALL

When in doubt, say the golden rule out loud: **eat the fruit, never cut the tree** — then ask a grown-up you trust. Questions are free; mistakes are not.

A TERM-LENGTH LESSON PLANNER

For Teachers: The 12-Week Money Journey

Each chapter is a scene, and one scene fills a comfortable lesson; two a week carries a class through the whole story in a single term. Read the chapter aloud — or cast it and act it out, since nearly every chapter is written as a scene — then close with its **YOUR TURN** box as the discussion starter. **FROM MANAHIL'S GREEN NOTEBOOK** makes a painless two-minute recap the next morning, and each week's goal sits in the final column below. Week 12 graduates the class with the Big Test and a certificate ceremony.

A tip from classrooms that have run it: hand every child a green notebook on day one. They write what Manahil writes — and by week twelve they are holding a book they wrote themselves.

Wk	Read	Classroom activity	The goal
1	Ch 1–2	Money show-and-tell: bring an old coin or note; act out the fisherman-and-mangoes scene.	What money is; the two doors.
2	Ch 3	Build a class three-jar budget for an imaginary AED 1,000; label real jars. (Worksheet 1)	Needs vs wants; budgeting.
3	Ch 4–5	Opportunity-cost skits; home asset-hunt — report one asset and one non-asset.	Spending vs owning; the golden rule.
4	Ch 6	Inflation interviews with elders (Worksheet 5); build a then-vs-now price wall.	Inflation and self-defence.
5	Ch 7	Stage the veranda scene: farmer, neighbour one, neighbour two; chant the three checks.	Riba, fairness, the halal filter idea.
6	Ch 8–9	Four-flavours matching game; mock Mudarabah: class 'deposits' with a student banker.	Returns; Islamic banking.
7	Ch 10–11	Class 'owns' the bookshelf and rents it out (Sukuk demo); company-detective hunt (Worksheet 6).	Sukuk; halal shares.
8	Ch 12–14	Fund-basket pooling game; gold coins vs bangles debate; map the nearest mall as a REIT.	Funds, gold, property.
9	Ch 15–16	One-day class bake/craft sale with a real P&L; (Worksheet 3); red-light quiz bee.	Business; what to skip.
10	Ch 17–18	Rule-of-72 relay races; the egg-and-basket demonstration; draw your own mix (Worksheet 2).	Compounding; diversification.
11	Ch 19–20	Re-enact the night Manahil saved Sara; Zakat coin-grid craft with 100 paper coins.	Digital safety; Zakat.
12	Ch 21–22	Write family launch plans; read the Year One report aloud; sit the Big Test; ceremony!	Putting it all together.

Teacher's compass: keep every dirham-figure an *example*, praise questions over answers, invite a parent who invests (or a banker) for week 6, and let students disagree — a child who can argue about money can defend hers. Above all, let Sara be funny — a class remembers what made it laugh.

YOUR SPACE

My Notes & Questions

Every good investor keeps notes. Park your thoughts here — and bring the questions to a grown-up you trust.

QUESTIONS I WANT TO ASK A GROWN-UP

THINGS I NOTICED ABOUT MONEY THIS WEEK

MY OWN IDEAS FOR MY GARDEN

SIGN IT TOGETHER

The Family Money Pledge

Knowledge becomes power the day you promise to use it. Read each line aloud together — then sign, reader and grown-up, side by side.

- ✓ I will treat my capital like a tree: **eat the fruit, never cut the trunk**.
- ✓ Only **halal** earning enters my garden — I will run the three checks, every time.
- ✓ I will give every dirham a job: **spend, save, give** — in that written order, not by mood.
- ✓ I will **never share my OTP or PIN** with anyone. Not a caller, not a message, not a friend.
- ✓ If a return sounds like magic, I will say the magic word back: **no**.
- ✓ I will pay my **Zakat** with pride and measure my garden every Eid.
- ✓ From **every income** my garden earns, a chosen share goes to those in need as **sadaqah** — making Allah a partner in my wealth and inviting **barakah**.
- ✓ I will ask questions before money moves — because questions are free, mistakes are not.

SIGNED — THE FUTURE MILLIONAIRE

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SIGNED — A PROUD GROWN-UP

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DATE THE PLEDGE WAS MADE

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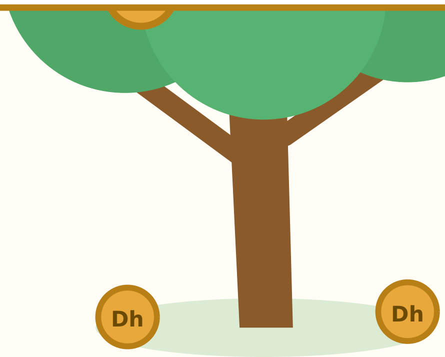
ONE FAMILY, ONE GARDEN

Pin this page to the fridge. A promise everyone can see is a promise everyone keeps.



Certificate of the Future Millionaire

This certifies that the reader below understands capital, riba and the halal filter, Sukuk, dividends, capital gains, compounding, inflation, digital-money safety and Zakat — lives by the golden rule, *eat the fruit, never cut the tree* — and is hereby trusted with her first AED 100,000.

Name of the Future Millionaire

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School & class

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Date the tree was planted

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Witnessed by (a proud grown-up or teacher)

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About this book. Written by Nabeel Shaikh, FCA, for Manahil Shaikh — and shared so classrooms everywhere can grow young halal investors. All figures, prices and the 10% rate are teaching examples; real returns vary and are never guaranteed. This book is education, not financial or religious advice: real decisions for a minor are made by parents or guardians, with a licensed advisor and their own trusted scholars.

About the author. Nabeel Shaikh — FCA, MSc, FMVA — is an ex-Big 4 professional and investment banker with 20 years of experience, and the founder of **YallaStartup.com**, a GCC-based venture builder. Connect: linkedin.com/in/nabeilschaik.